

puremacro: macroeconometrics and quantitative macroeconomics on the core scientific-Python stack

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Summary

puremacro is a Python library for empirical macroeconomics and for solving quantitative macroeconomic models. It gives researchers, instructors and students one consistent interface to the field's standard methods, and a way to check the library's numbers on the machine that produces them.

On the empirical side it covers vector autoregressions (VARs) with recursive, long-run, sign, sign-zero, narrative and external-instrument identification ([Antolín-Díaz & Rubio-Ramírez, 2018](#); [Blanchard & Quah, 1989](#); [Mertens & Ravn, 2013](#); [Rubio-Ramírez et al., 2010](#); [Sims, 1980](#); [Stock & Watson, 2018](#); [Uhlig, 2005](#)); factor-augmented VARs ([Bernanke et al., 2005](#)); local projections ([Jordà, 2005](#)); ARCH, GARCH and GARCH-MIDAS volatility models ([Bollerslev, 1986](#); [Engle, 1982](#); [Engle et al., 2013](#)); autocorrelation-robust and weak-instrument-robust inference ([Anderson & Rubin, 1949](#); [Montiel Olea & Pflueger, 2013](#); [Newey & West, 1987](#)); dynamic panels ([Arellano & Bond, 1991](#)); difference-in-differences and synthetic control ([Abadie et al., 2010](#); [Arkhangelsky et al., 2021](#)); mixed-frequency nowcasting ([Bańbura & Modugno, 2014](#); [Giannone et al., 2008](#)); and text-based uncertainty indices ([Baker et al., 2016](#)). On the modelling side it solves dynamic programs by value-function iteration and endogenous grids ([Carroll, 2006](#); [Iskhakov et al., 2017](#)); heterogeneous-agent economies, including sequence-space HANK models ([Aiyagari, 1994](#); [Auclert et al., 2021](#); [Young, 2010](#)); continuous-time models ([Achdou et al., 2022](#)); projection methods on Chebyshev, finite-element and Smolyak grids ([Judd, 1992](#); [Krueger & Kubler, 2004](#); [McGrattan, 1996](#); [Smolyak, 1963](#)); linear rational-expectations (DSGE) models; quantitative spatial and trade models ([Allen & Arkolakis, 2014](#); [Caliendo & Parro, 2015](#)); and climate-economy models ([Golosov et al., 2014](#); [Nordhaus, 2018](#)).

Its estimators and solvers are written against NumPy ([Harris et al., 2020](#)), SciPy ([Virtanen et al., 2020](#)), pandas ([McKinney, 2010](#)) and Matplotlib ([Hunter, 2007](#)) alone, and the package contains no compiled code of its own. The same code therefore also runs in a web browser under Pyodide ([The Pyodide development team, 2021](#)), which ships those libraries compiled to WebAssembly.

Statement of need

An applied macroeconomist's toolkit typically spans several ecosystems: reduced-form time series and panel econometrics from Python's statsmodels ([Seabold & Perktold, 2010](#)), arch ([Sheppard, 2025a](#)) and linearmodels ([Sheppard, 2025b](#)); structural identification from MATLAB toolboxes or R packages such as vars and lpirfs ([Adämmer, 2019](#); [Pfaff, 2008](#)); DSGE analysis in Dynare ([Adjemian et al., 2024](#)), which runs under MATLAB or GNU Octave; and heterogeneous-agent models in Python codes accelerated with Numba ([Auclert et al., 2021](#); [Batista et al., 2024](#); [Carroll et al., 2018](#)). Each tool is good at what it does, but combining them means several installations, often several languages, sometimes a commercial licence, and conventions that change from package to package. The cost is highest in teaching, where installation

42 problems consume class time and students' machines (managed laptops, low-end hardware,
43 tablets) may not support the full stack.

44 puremacro is written for that audience: instructors, students and applied researchers in
45 macroeconomics. It puts common estimators and models behind one set of conventions (shared
46 arguments such as lags, horizon and ci, and immutable result objects with plotting and table
47 export), keeps the dependencies of its numerical code to four ubiquitous libraries, and ships
48 the evidence needed to trust its output: galleries of checks that users can run themselves.

49 State of the field

50 statsmodels, arch and linearmodels are the reference Python implementations of reduced-form
51 time series, conditional volatility and panel and instrumental-variable estimation. puremacro
52 does not aim to replace them; it uses them as test oracles (see *Software design*). They do not,
53 however, implement the identification schemes that define structural macroeconometrics (sign,
54 sign-zero, narrative and external-instrument restrictions), nor do they solve heterogeneous-agent
55 or general-equilibrium models. For models, widely used tools are Dynare, the sequence-space
56 Jacobian toolkit, HARK and QuantEcon.py. In their domains they are more mature than
57 puremacro and, for large heterogeneous-agent problems, faster: puremacro trades speed for
58 portability.

59 That portability can be stated precisely. As of September 2026 the Pyodide distribution
60 includes NumPy, SciPy, pandas, Matplotlib and statsmodels, but not arch, linearmodels or
61 Numba; arch and linearmodels publish no pure-Python wheels that a browser could install
62 at run time; and HARK and QuantEcon.py declare Numba as a required dependency, while
63 the sequence-space Jacobian toolkit uses it in its core modules. In a browser, the volatility,
64 panel-IV and heterogeneous-agent layers of the usual stack are therefore unavailable, and
65 Dynare needs a different language runtime altogether.

66 This also answers the build-versus-contribute question. Individual estimators could be
67 contributed to existing packages, and some would be welcome there. What cannot be
68 contributed is the property that makes the collection usable on a constrained machine: one
69 import surface whose numerical code depends on nothing beyond four core libraries. That is
70 an invariant of the whole library, enforced by tests, not a feature that can be added to another
71 project's dependency graph.

72 Software design

73 **An import invariant.** Library modules import NumPy, SciPy, pandas and Matplotlib (plus
74 requests, in the data layer) at module scope; anything else, from Parquet support to optional
75 accelerators, is optional and imported only when available. Two tests enforce the rule against
76 the packages most likely to leak in. The first imports each of the 597 library modules (examples,
77 teaching helpers, text-scraping sources and optional Numba kernels are excluded) and fails
78 if statsmodels, linearmodels, arch or the scraping packages bs4, pdfplumber and pypdf have
79 entered sys.modules. The second repeats the sweep in a subprocess in which those packages
80 cannot be imported, so a module that would break on a machine without them fails in
81 continuous integration (CI) on a machine that has them. The wheel is pure Python, and its
82 base install adds only requests to the four core libraries; the Parquet and Excel engines are an
83 optional extra.

84 **Oracles that do not ship.** The packages forbidden at run time are the test suite's references.
85 Scripts in the repository run statsmodels, arch, linearmodels and esda once on fixed inputs
86 and store their outputs as package data, so the validation gallery can compare against them
87 without importing them; an opt-in test marker recomputes the stored outputs with the installed

88 packages to detect drift. The reference implementations thus certify the library without
89 becoming its dependencies, which is what lets breadth and portability coexist.

90 **Degrading rather than failing.** Where an external tool does better, puremacro uses it if present:
91 seasonal adjustment calls X-13ARIMA-SEATS through statsmodels when both are installed
92 and otherwise falls back to a native X-11. A runtime module detects the host (CPython
93 or Pyodide), the device class and the four capabilities that differ away from a workstation
94 (sockets, Parquet, threads and a writable filesystem), and offers opt-in adaptations such as a
95 browser fetch transport. A few dynamic-programming and projection solvers have optional
96 Numba kernels and experimental MLX and CuPy paths; NumPy remains the reference path
97 and the one tested in CI.

98 **Costs.** Writing everything in vectorised NumPy makes large heterogeneous-agent problems
99 slower than in JIT-compiled toolkits, and derivatives that other libraries obtain by automatic
100 differentiation must be coded by hand. The browser is a best-effort target rather than a
101 supported one: Parquet and Excel files need engines that not every Pyodide distribution
102 provides. A headless harness in the repository runs the library in Node.js against a pinned
103 Pyodide, and an opt-in release gate installs the package there exactly as the playground does
104 and runs a 31-test smoke subset of the suite. On 3 October 2026 the same harness ran the
105 whole validation gallery inside Pyodide 0.28.3 and 314.0.5 (the version the playground pins):
106 all 114 checks passed on both, in about 36 to 38 seconds against 21 on the desktop, with
107 the same pass flags everywhere and four margins differing between WebAssembly and native
108 arithmetic by at most 5×10^{-4} .

109 **Scale.** Version 4.6.0 comprises about 810 modules and 282,000 lines of Python, exercised by
110 about 19,100 tests, of which CI runs 18,900 on Linux, macOS and Windows under Python
111 3.11–3.13 on every push and the remaining slow, reference and replication tests weekly and on
112 every release tag, where they gate publication. Before a release is tagged, a script checks the
113 suite against a recorded baseline, the import invariant, a snapshot of the public API that must
114 be regenerated deliberately when the interface changes, that every shipped file still parses on
115 the oldest supported Python, and that the version string agrees across the package metadata,
116 changelog and citation file.

117 Verification

118 The validation gallery, `puremacro.validation.scorecard()`, runs 114 checks across 16
119 subsystems in under a minute, with none of the oracle packages installed; all pass (Figure 1).
120 The checks differ in strength, and each records its reference. Twenty-one compare against an
121 external reference: stored outputs of statsmodels, arch, linearmodels and esda, SciPy results
122 computed at run time, a published table, or, for the trade model, the solution of the author's
123 legacy MATLAB implementation on the same input-output table. Agreement with independent
124 implementations is typically at machine precision (median relative difference of order 10^{-15});
125 the exception is GARCH, whose estimates differ from arch's by up to 0.35% because the two
126 packages use different optimisers. Thirty-one checks compare against analytical results, and
127 62 test internal consistency, such as agreement between alternative algorithms and recovery of
128 parameters from simulated data.

129 A separate replication gallery, `puremacro.replication.scorecard()`, reproduces published
130 estimates of the return to schooling (Card, 1995), a textbook logit of married women's labour-
131 force participation on Mroz's (1987) data, and the output effect of tax changes (Romer &
132 Romer, 2010), as well as two qualitative predictions of incomplete-markets models (Aiyagari,
133 1994; Huggett, 1993): precautionary saving holds the interest rate below the rate of time
134 preference, and the rate falls as income risk rises. Most model solvers (sequence-space,
135 continuous-time, spatial, and climate) are covered by unit tests but not yet by gallery checks;
136 the trade model gained its first four checks in 4.6.0, on a 77-country, 11-sector OECD table
137 rebuilt from a clean release.

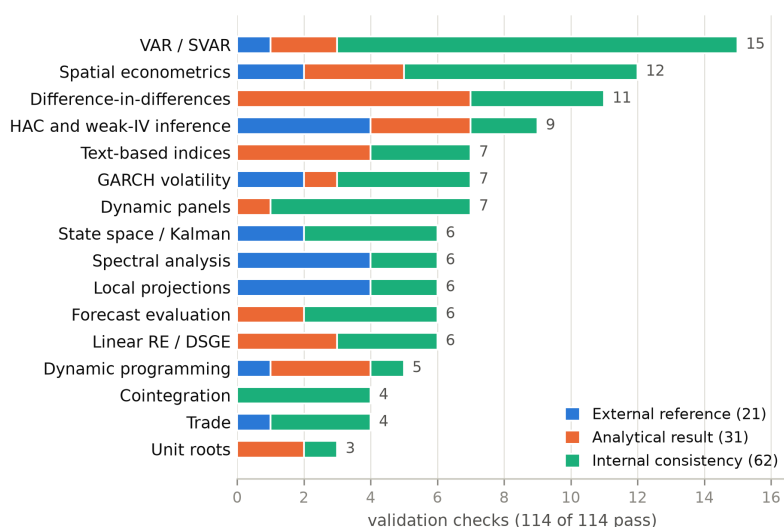


Figure 1: The validation gallery of puremacro 4.6.0: 114 checks in 16 subsystems, by kind of reference; all pass. *External reference*: stored outputs of statsmodels, arch, linearmodels or esda, SciPy computed at run time, or a published table. *Analytical result*: a closed form, or an effect planted in simulated data. *Internal consistency*: agreement between alternative algorithms, identities that correct output must satisfy, or recovery of parameters from simulated data. Regenerate with `python paper/make_scorecard_fig.py`.

Research impact statement

puremacro is young (public since July 2026) and has not yet been used in published research or by other packages. Its significance is near-term, and rests on evidence a reviewer can check.

Teaching. The library was written for, and is used in, the author's course *Macroeconomía Avanzada* at ITAM, whose Fall 2026 edition builds its computational material on it. The course's 22 Spanish lesson notebooks are in the repository (notebooks/course), and 20 of them call puremacro directly.

Reproducible material. The repository contains 70 bilingual (English/Spanish) pairs of worked-example notebooks; all of them, with the lesson notebooks, are also published as a JupyterLite ([JupyterLite contributors, 2021](https://jupyterlite.github.io)) site that runs them in the browser.

Community readiness. The package is released on PyPI under the MIT licence, with documentation at <https://jalonso1979.github.io/puremacro/>, contribution guidelines, and CI on three operating systems.

AI usage disclosure

Generative AI was used extensively in writing puremacro, its documentation and this paper. Anthropic's Claude models, used through the Claude Code agent (Claude Opus 5, Claude Opus 5.5, Claude Fable 5 and Claude Fable 5.1), generated or co-wrote much of the code, tests, documentation and notebooks: 205 of the 344 commits in the public repository carry a Claude co-author trailer. Google's Jules coding agent contributed 20 pull requests (refactoring, performance and test improvements), each reviewed and merged by the author. Claude also drafted and revised this paper, including checking its claims against the code and its references against Crossref.

The author set the scope and made the core design decisions (the import invariant, validation against stored outputs of reference implementations, and the shared interface conventions) and

reviewed, edited and validated all AI-assisted output before it was merged. Correctness does not rest on that review alone: it is checked by the test suite, the validation and replication galleries, and CI.

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